A Strong Counter

Mohammed Imran, the second of four siblings of a retail pharmacist, was born and raised in Hyderabad. "To vote is to be empowered," he says, admitting that urban voter apathy is a problem. "Our Constitution guarantees this fundamental right and the freedom to choose our leaders. I will definitely vote and will also encourage my friends to do so. Peace nationally and economic development will drive my voting choice." A prize-winning debater, it is no surprise that the articulate Congress MP Shashi Tharoor is his favourite political leader. For him, a party's prime minister face does not matter much as "ours is a federal structure and not a one-man show". For Imran, India's image in the world and domestic unemployment are serious issues. "It takes a lot of time and effort to build a positive, credible image across the world. India is regarded as one of the fastest growing economies and has risen to prominence at the global high table. That said, there have been instances where India has received flak. Regional protests have raised important questions about government actions that could destroy the secular political fabric of the country," he says. For him, the INDIA bloc is critical. "We need a strong, effective Opposition, irrespective of political parties. A strong Opposition is essential for an effective government," he says. ■

-Amarnath K. Menon



MOHAMMED IMRAN, 26

IT executive

Lok Sabha constituency: Hyderabad, Telangana

Top 3 demands:
Sustainable development, better standard of living and improved literacy rate

"We need a strong, effective Opposition...it's essential for an effective government"



BOTH EARS TO THE GROUND

Elections for Anuradha Jangra are a time to take stock of the country and its future and she takes her voting rights seriously. Despite being a student on a campus where anti-BJP sloganeering is not uncommon, Jangra only trusts the reality on the ground. "Despite the pandemic and several raging conflicts, India's economic growth has been impressive... in terms of improvements in infrastructure and availability of amenities," she says. Jangra feels votes should not be influenced by short-lived controversies. "What appeals to me is something with a longer shelf life. For example, increased participation of

A BIG HAND FOR SMALL BIZ

Despite only recently relocating to Noida, Lankapalli Rajendra Bharath has ensured that his voter's card has been updated, for he strongly believes in exercising his right to vote. A start-up founder himself, he is quite concerned about the state of the small and medium-sized businesses in the country. "While GST and other digitalisation measures have enhanced business formalisation, they have also made it unviable for many small entrepreneurs," he says.

Bharath considers local governance issues and the autonomy of individual institutions to be critical, and feels they have been compromised right now. He hopes the winning party will bring in some change, decentralise power to facilitate effective grassroots change. He believes the top three priorities for the new government should